Z-11018/14/2025-Digital Agriculture [169171]
Government of India
Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
Digital Agriculture Division
***

Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi
Dated the 30th September, 2025

Meeting Notice

Subject: 2nd AgriStack Use Cases Committee Meeting on AgriStack Data Sharing Framework scheduled for **07.10.2025 at 11:00 AM – reg.**

The undersigned is directed to refer to the subject cited above and to convey that Additional Secretary (Digital Agriculture) will chair the meeting of the committee, constituted vide order dated 06.08.2025 (copy enclosed), on **07.10.2025** at **11:00 AM** in **CR-147**, Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi. The last minutes of the committee meeting is also attached for reference.

2. In this regard, the VC link for outstation participants is as under:

https://cdbkochi.webex.com/cdbkochi/j.php?MTID=m3d9d07a64a33c752b43ae76c7c893e02
Tuesday, October 7, 2025 11:00 AM | Meeting number: 2511 098 9800 | Password: 8765921

3. In view of the above, it is requested to make it convenient to attend the meeting.

Encl: As above.

(Chandan kumar)
Under Secretary (Digital)
Email: us-it@nic.in
Ph: 011-23382926

To

All the committee members.

Copy to:

1. Shri Rajiv Chawla, Chief Knowledge Officer & Advisor, DA&FW
2. PPS to Additional Secretary (Digital, DA&FW)
3. CPMU-Agristack team

Z-11018/14/2025-Digital Agriculture
Government of India
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Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi
Dated the 06th August, 2025

OFFICE ORDER

Subject: Constitution of Agri Stack use case Committee– reg.

With the approval of the Competent Authority, the **Agri Stack Use- Case Committee** has been constituted to ensure a uniform and seamless experience for onboarding of Agri Stack Information Users (AIUs) across the country while respecting the autonomy of States

2. The composition of the Committee is as under:

i.	Additional Secretary (Digital Agriculture), DA&FW	- Chairperson
ii.	Joint Secretary/Advisor (PM-Kisan), MoA&FW	- Member
iii.	Joint Secretary (Digital Agriculture), MoA&FW	- Member
iv.	Joint Secretary (PMFBY), MoA&FW	- Member
v.	Deputy Director General, NIC	- Member
vi.	Two State Government Representatives (Secretary Agri/Revenue)	- Members
vii.	Representative, MeitY	- Member
viii.	Representative, Department of Land Records	- Member
ix.	Technical Experts in Data Governance, DPI, Agritech	- Co-opted Members
x.	Director (Digital Agriculture), DA&FW	- Member Secretary

3. **Terms of Reference (ToR) of the Committee are as under:**

i. Study and benchmark best practices from other DPIs (e.g., Aadhaar, UPI, Health Stack) for policies, frameworks and procedures for AIU onboarding.
ii. Support States in setting up Agri Stack Data Governance Unit that will be responsible for enabling Use-cases in the States.
iii. Develop an Authorization Framework to be used by States to evaluate and facilitate AIU access, including:
    - Eligibility criteria for various user categories:
        - Central Government Departments and Public Schemes
        - Research institutions and academia
        - Agritech startups and private sector
        - Financial institutions offering agri-credit or insurance
    - SOPs for Application Review:
        - Creation of Evaluation templates, scoring matrices, and risk assessments
    - Standardized Contract/MoU templates for onboarding AIUs
iv. Finalize Data Classification & Sharing Guidelines:
    - Categorize data into layers (e.g., demographic (personal), aggregated, Non-PII, etc.)
    - Define rules and principles for who can access what kind of data based on purpose and legal mandates
    - Design guidelines to ensure:
        - Minimal data sharing based on "need to know"
        - Purpose limitation and accountability
        - Inclusion of consent architecture (where applicable)
v. Coordination with State Governments for:
    - Approval of Agri Stack data usage in Central Schemes (e.g., PM-Kisan)
    - Onboarding of Private or research use-cases involving multiple jurisdictions
vi. Finalizing Security & Compliance Protocols for AIUs

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vii. Finalize Guidelines on Onboarding of AIUs on sandbox

- Define onboarding process for Technical sandbox
- Establish Technical Evaluation checklist for successful exit from Technical sandbox into production APIs
- Guidelines for Annual/bi-annual compliance audits by States of AIUs
- Guidelines for Grievance redressal protocols to be established by States

viii. Finalization of Audit Mechanism for AIUs

ix. Support Strategic Governance and Capacity Building:

-
- Provide model policies and toolkits for States to set up their own AIU governance frameworks
- Capacity building programs for State-level officials
- Encourage responsible innovation and pilot projects by States

x. Authorization AIUs for access to Aggregated Digital Crop Survey data, Aggregated Farmer Registry data and Restricted Support Registries data.

xi. Help define and monitor SLA for State's Agri Stack Data Governance Unit for AIU onboarding

4. **Working Procedure:**

i. The Committee shall convene at least once every 30 days.
ii. Minutes of meetings shall be shared with all States that have signed the Agri Stack DPI MoU.
iii. The Committee may seek expert advice or consult domain-specific stakeholders on a need basis.
iv. Monthly meetings with State's Agri Stack Data Governance Unit to ensure SLA for AIU onboarding.

Chandan Kumar 6/8/25

(Chandan Kumar)
Under Secretary to the Government of India
Ph: 011-23382926
Email: us-it@nic.in

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Copy to :

i. Officers/ Officials concerned

Copy for information to:

i. PPS to Secretary, DA&FW
ii. PPS to AS (Digital Agriculture)
iii. PS to Advisor (Digital Agriculture)

Minutes of the 1st AgriStack Use Cases Committee Meeting on AgriStack Data Sharing Framework

A meeting of the AgriStack Use Cases Committee was held on 4th September 2025 under the Chairmanship of Dr. Pramod Kumar Meherda, Additional Secretary, Digital Agriculture, Department of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare. The list of participants is given in Annexure.

Agenda of the Meeting:

To deliberate on the framework for data sharing under AgriStack and its role in enabling farmer-centric service delivery. The meeting was convened to examine the governance framework between the States and the Centre, consider principles of data minimization and consent, discuss the process of onboarding AgriStack Information Users (AIUs), and deliberate on the technical and regulatory mechanisms required for secure and efficient data sharing.

Summary of the Meeting:

1. AgriStack Governance

1.1 The Committee noted that AgriStack is a federated system, where the ownership and fiduciary responsibility of farmer data rests with the States. Access and use of such data will be determined in accordance with the policies and decisions of the respective State Governments.

1.2 The Ministry's role is to serve as a facilitator by prescribing guidelines, standards, and technical safeguards, and by supporting States in ensuring uniformity and interoperability, while the data itself remains under the custody of the States.

2. Principle of Data Minimization and Consent

2.1 The Committee emphasized that data sharing must follow the principle of minimization, where only the data strictly required for a specific purpose is shared. For example, in PM-Kisan, only a Yes/No validation of Farmer ID is sufficient without disclosing full land or demographic details.

2.2 Every request for data must include a clear justification for its use. Farmer consent must be obtained wherever applicable, and accountability for the use of the data will rest with the requesting entity.

3. Eligibility and Onboarding of Agricultural Information Users (AIUs)

3.1 It was agreed that not all Government or private organizations will automatically qualify as AgriStack Information Users. Clear eligibility criteria must be defined for granting access.

3.2 The onboarding process will include sandbox testing with sample data, audits of systems, technical evaluation, and staged access to production APIs. Sandbox environments may also be used for pilots and hackathons without granting access to live data.

4. API Framework and Reverse Data Sharing

4.1 The Committee recommended adopting an API-first approach. Data dumps are to be avoided; external systems should retain only identifiers such as Farmer ID and obtain real-time data through APIs.

4.2 A two-level API structure will be adopted: the first API for Farmer ID authentication, and the second for the retrieval of related data. Private AIUs will be required to provide reverse APIs so that any farmer-level data generated in their systems is also shared back with AgriStack.

5. Data Oversight, Audit, and Risk Management

5.1 All requests and approvals for data access must be recorded and subject to periodic audit. Oversight mechanisms must ensure that data is used only for approved purposes and discontinued if consent is withdrawn.

5.2 A broadcast and update mechanism will be created to push corrections and changes in AgriStack data to all connected systems, ensuring consistency and accuracy.

5.3 The Committee cautioned that misuse of AgriStack data by any entity could damage public trust. To prevent this, approvals must be based on strict checklists and SOPs.

6. Legal, Regulatory, and Contractual Framework

6.1 Standardized MOUs and contracts should be drafted for data sharing, covering purpose limitation, consent, audits, grievance redressal, reverse API provisions, and liabilities.

6.2 The framework must align with applicable laws, including the DPDP Act, Aadhaar Act, and Digital India Act, ensuring both personal and non-personal data is managed responsibly.

7. Cross-sector Learning and Coordination

7.1 The Committee agreed that lessons should be drawn from other sectoral stacks such as Health, Food, Rural Development and Labour.

7.2 A representative from the health sector will be invited to the Committee to provide cross-sector inputs.

7.3 The Ministry will approach major data-owning departments to obtain their views and strengthen coordination.

7.4 Accordingly, a member from M/o Labour & Employment, Food, Rural Development, and the National Health Authority may also be opted in this committee.

8. Strengthening State Capacity

8.1 It was noted that States viz. Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan are establishing State Data Governance Units to manage AgriStack data.

8.2 The Committee stressed the need for training and capacity building of State officials so that approvals, compliance, and monitoring can be effectively carried out.

9. Use Cases and System Benefits

9.1 AgriStack data supports critical use cases, including PM-Kisan validation, MSP operations, Soil Health Cards, crop surveys, DSS platforms, and fraud detection.

9.2 These use cases were recognized as demonstrating how AgriStack can support efficient schemes, reduce duplication, and deliver improved services to farmers.

10. Draft Data Sharing Policy

10.1 It was resolved that the Committee will prepare a Draft Data Sharing Policy within two weeks, consolidating the principles agreed in the meeting.

10.2 The draft policy will be circulated among all members for feedback and review.

10.3 The Committee will reconvene in the next meeting to deliberate on the draft and finalize it for approval.

Action Items of the Meeting

Work Designated to	Details
Committee Secretariat	Prepare a draft Data Sharing Policy within two weeks and circulate to members.
Committee	Define eligibility criteria and onboarding process for AIUs (sandbox, pre-audit, evaluation, phased access).
MoA&FW	Draft standardized MOUs/contracts covering consent, purpose, audit, grievance redressal, reverse APIs, and liabilities.
NIC / States	Implement an API-first framework with a two-level API structure; enforce reverse APIs.
States & Committee	Ensure logging and auditing of all requests and approvals; conduct periodic compliance checks.
Committee Secretariat	Prepare a draft Data Sharing Policy within two weeks and circulate to members.
Committee	Define eligibility criteria and onboarding process for AIUs (sandbox, pre-audit, evaluation, phased access).

The meeting ended with a Vote of Thanks to the Chair.

Annexure

The following were present in the meeting:

1. Shri Pramod Kumar Meherda, Additional Secretary, MoA&FW
2. Shri Rajeev Chawla, CKO, NFWPIS
3. Shri Prashant Mittal, DDG, NIC
4. Ms. Sunita Jain, Director, NIC
5. Shri N. Samrathram, Ex. Sr. Technical Director, NIC
6. Shri Vikas Rastogi, Principal Secretary, Agriculture, Maharashtra
7. Shri Raj Kumar, Deputy Director, Dept. of Land Resources,
8. Shri Chandan Kumar, Under Secretary, Digita, DA&FW
9. Representatives from State Governments and Land Departments
10. Shri Prakash Jairam, CPMU Team
11. Shri Vishal Sharma, CPMU Team
12. Shri Akhil Paul, CPMU Team
13. 'Shri Sahid Shekh, CPMU Team